CASE STUDY · SURVEY ANALYTICS · CONSUMER BEHAVIOUR

How did music festival-goers change after COVID-19? From 1,000+ survey responses to clear business insights

I designed an international, three-language survey, cleaned and validated the data, built a statistical model in SPSS and translated the results into practical recommendations for festival organisers on pricing, communication and audience segmentation.

Anaïs Kovaleski · Data Analyst · portfolio-anaiskova.vercel.app · Based on my PhD research, University of Aveiro (2025)

1,000+
responses collected, validated into a final sample of 402

8+
countries of residence (BR, NL, PT, FR, LU, ES…)

3
survey languages: Portuguese, English, French

40
variables in the explanatory model

THE BUSINESS QUESTION

Festivals reopened after the pandemic, but did their audiences come back the same? Organisers needed to know **what changed** in how people choose, plan and spend at festivals, and **which audience profiles** changed the most, in order to adjust pricing, communication and event formats.

THE DATA

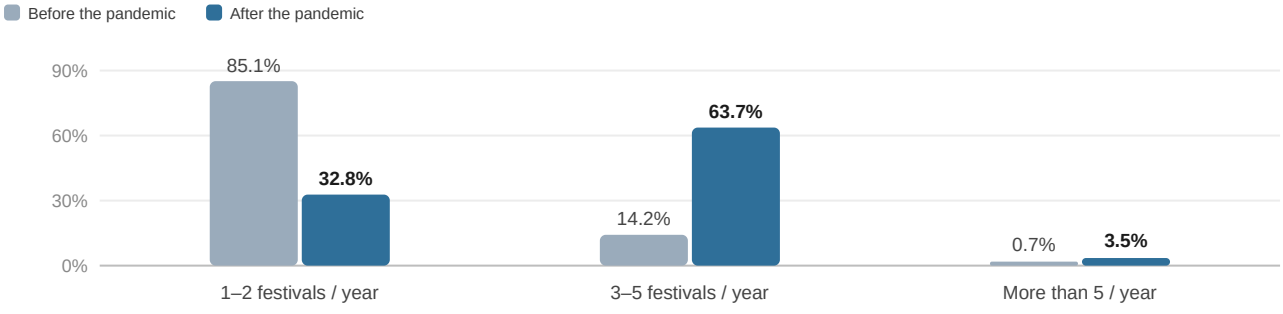
Online questionnaire built on the University of Aveiro platform and distributed through festival communities, social media and festival organisers (Sept–Oct 2025). Respondents compared their behaviour **before and after** the pandemic across three phases: participation, pre-event planning and behaviour during the event. Sample: 61% women, mostly 18–34, 73% employed.

HOW I WORKED

1. **Scoping.** Two systematic literature reviews (147 and 54 studies) to define the variables and measurement scales.
2. **Survey design.** Questionnaire in 3 languages, pre-tested and reviewed before launch; consent and data-protection approval.
3. **Data quality.** Screened 1,000+ responses for eligibility, completeness, input errors and outliers, keeping 402 valid cases for analysis.
4. **Dimension reduction.** Factor analysis (PCA) to group 12 planning items into 3 clear drivers, explaining 83% of the variance; reliability α = 0.92–0.96.
5. **Testing.** Before/after comparisons (paired t-test, Wilcoxon) and group differences (t-test, Kruskal–Wallis, Spearman).
6. **Modelling.** Multiple linear and binary logistic regression to find which factors explain each change.

SPSS · Survey design · Data cleaning · Factor analysis · Hypothesis testing · Regression · Segmentation

Festival attendance became more frequent after the pandemic
Share of respondents by number of festivals attended per year (n = 402)



Wilcoxon signed-rank test: Z = −14.15, p < 0.001. The share attending 3–5 festivals a year rose from 14% to 64%.

RESULTS

What the data showed

+50 pts

in the share of people attending **3–5 festivals a year**. Demand came back stronger, with a clear preference for **outdoor events**.

Price-sensitive, but still spending

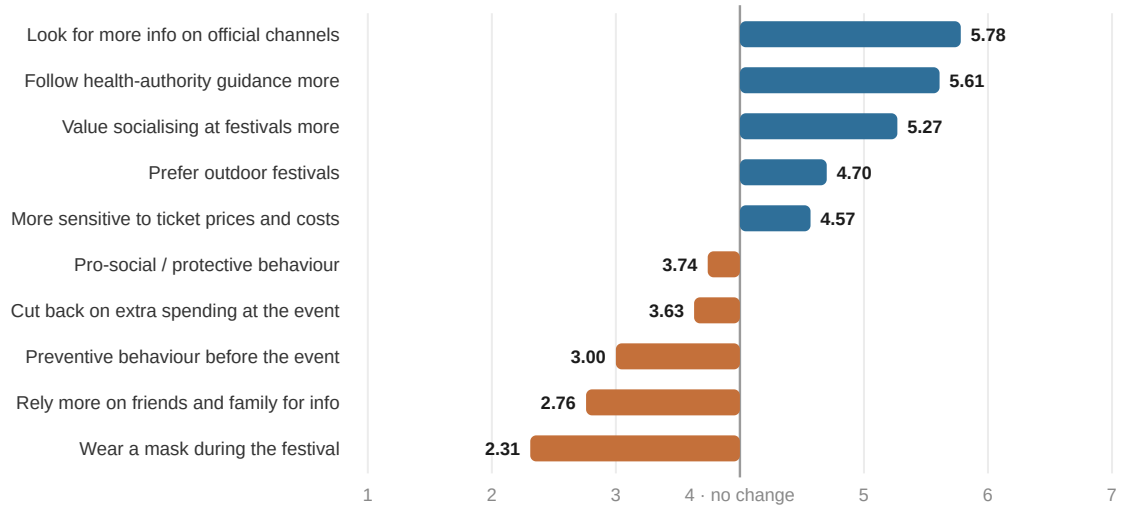
Price and cost sensitivity was the **strongest planning driver** (33% of variance), yet there was **no clear cutback** in spending once people were at the festival.

Official channels win

People now rely much more on **official festival websites and social media**, and much less on friends and family, to decide whether to go.

Where behaviour changed the most

Average agreement with each statement after the pandemic, on a 1–7 scale. The centre line (4) means "no change"; bars to the right mean more agreement.



n = 402. All differences from the midpoint are statistically significant (one-sample t-tests, $p < 0.01$). Values below 4 mean respondents disagreed that the behaviour increased. Some rows are averages of validated multi-item scales.

WHAT EXPLAINS THE CHANGES

The regression models showed that the changes were **not the same for everyone**. The strongest explanatory factors were **country of residence**, **perceived risk** and **motivations**, with lifestyle and personality mattering for specific behaviours. In other words, the audience splits into segments that respond differently, and one message or price strategy will not fit all of them.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ORGANISERS

- → **Win the ticket decision on price.** Show the full cost up front and offer tiered ticket options; on-site spending has held up, so the barrier is getting people to buy.
- → **Invest in official channels.** Clear, up-to-date information on the website and social media now drives the decision to attend.
- → **Segment the audience** by country, risk perception and motivation to tailor formats and messages.
- → **Prioritise outdoor formats**; treat online events as a complement, not a substitute.